MODULE 06 · DOMAIN 2 - OUTPUT EVALUATION AND VALIDATION

Criteria First

Judging accuracy and completeness: what to measure an output against, in what order, and what "good enough" means.

DOMAIN 2 of 7 EXAM WEIGHT 21% MODULE 6 of 33

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Write the marking scheme before you mark the essays.

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Why criteria come first

- **Fluency is not quality.** Without criteria, confident prose wins by default.
- **One standard for every reviewer.** Two people judging the same draft should reach the same verdict.
- **A basis for the decision.** Use, iterate or escalate only means something against a standard.
- **Anthropic's own order:** define success criteria and a way to test them before you write the prompt.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Criteria and thresholds are set before anything is scored.

Criteria that hold up

CRITERION	CHECKED AGAINST
Accuracy	The source material, records or trusted references
Completeness	The specification: every required item, at the required depth
Relevance	The audience and the decision the output must support
Format and length	What was asked for
Consistency	Itself: no contradictions between sections
House standards	Terminology, tone and style guides

THE TIEBREAKER

A valid criterion points at something outside the draft that you can check.

Criteria that only look like criteria

VALID

Checkable against something

- Figures match the site log
- Every contract section present
- Written for the client's panel
- Within the agreed word count

NOT VALID

Impressions of the draft

- It sounds confident
- It is long and detailed
- It cites lots of sources
- Claude says it is accurate

THE TIEBREAKER

Confidence, length, source count and self-assessment measure the draft's surface, not its quality.

Thresholds: what counts as good enough

- **Set the bar in advance.** For a client report: zero unsupported figures, every mandatory section.
- **Separate must-haves from nice-to-haves.** A missing must-have fails the draft.
- **Grade findings by severity:** critical, major, minor.
- **No threshold, no decision.** Every review ends in "mostly fine, I think".

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Criteria say what to look at. Thresholds say how good it must be.

The evaluation sequence

01

Restate criteria

And the threshold, before reading.

02

Read end to end

Get the whole picture first.

03

Compare

Against sources and the specification.

04

Document gaps

Location and severity of each.

05

Decide

Use, iterate or escalate.

ON THE EXAM

Document findings before you decide. The decision is the last step.

The criteria follow the purpose

OUTPUT	WHAT MATTERS MOST	MATTERS LESS
Steering group update	Accurate against the plan	Style flourishes
Client proposal	Every requirement answered	Internal shorthand
Team brainstorm	Range and relevance of ideas	Polish and proof
Board paper	Verified facts, scannable	Exhaustive detail

ON THE EXAM

There is no universal checklist. Weight the criteria by audience and purpose.

Accurate is not the same as complete

ACCURATE BUT INCOMPLETE

Every sentence is true

- Figures all correct
- Two critical findings left out
- The reader is misled by omission

COMPLETE BUT INACCURATE

Everything is covered

- Every section present
- One cost figure invented
- The reader is misled by error

THE TIEBREAKER

Every sentence true and the output still wrong? Check what is missing.

Completeness means depth, not just headings

- **Topic-level complete:** every required heading is present.
- **Still under-scoped:** the spec asks for three risk factors, and the section names one.
- **The fix:** map each requirement in the spec to where, and how fully, the draft meets it.
- **Claude can build that map**, a compliance matrix, for you to check.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Check every requirement against the depth the specification asks for, not just its heading.

The silent omission: one-sided outputs

- **A recommendation cites only the evidence for it**, while its own sources also contain costs and concerns.
- **Every citation checks out**, so a quick review passes it.
- **Ask:** what do the sources say that the output does not?
- **Prompt for balance:** "List the evidence in these sources against this recommendation."

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A recommendation that omits material counter-evidence from its own sources must be revised before use.

Using Claude to help you evaluate

- **Check against a checklist:** "Mark each criterion met or not met, with the evidence."
- **Surface weak claims:** "List every figure and claim that is not supported by the attached sources."
- **Map requirements:** "For each requirement, quote where the draft addresses it."
- **Then verify the check.** Claude's evaluation is evidence for you to review, not a verdict.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Claude can do the legwork of an evaluation. You still own the judgement. That is Discernment.

> Halden has a Claude-drafted proposal answering a hospital trust's specification for cleaning its non-clinical buildings.
>
> The trust's procurement panel will score it against the specification, and anything Halden promises becomes contractual.

Which set of criteria gives the strongest evaluation?

A Length, a confident tone and the number of sources cited

B Commitments accurate to Halden's real capability, every requirement answered, written for the panel

C A good readability score, plenty of headings and a sensible word count

D Claude rating its own draft highly, and the bid writer being happy with it

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which set of criteria gives the strongest evaluation?

A Length, a confident tone and the number of sources cited

Surface impressions. None checks whether the content is right.

B Commitments accurate to Halden's real capability, every requirement answered, written for the panel

Accuracy, completeness and relevance, each checkable.

C A good readability score, plenty of headings and a sensible word count

Presentation only. A readable proposal can still miss requirements.

D Claude rating its own draft highly, and the bid writer being happy with it

Self-assessment and preference are not evidence.

THE SIGNAL

Scored against a specification, and promises become contractual: accuracy, completeness, audience.

A Halden bid manager has a Claude-drafted response to a tender with forty questions and over a hundred individual requirements.

Before submission, she needs to be sure nothing required has been missed or only partly answered.

Which method best checks completeness?

A Read the response through and judge whether it feels complete

B Ask Claude whether its response is complete, and accept its answer

C Compare each answer's word count with the length allowed

D Map every requirement to where the response meets it, and how fully, then check the map

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which method best checks completeness?

A Read the response through and judge whether it feels complete

A feeling, not a check. A hundred requirements cannot be held in memory.

B Ask Claude whether its response is complete, and accept its answer

Self-assessment accepted without verification.

C Compare each answer's word count with the length allowed

Length says nothing about which requirements were met.

D Map every requirement to where the response meets it, and how fully, then check the map

Tests completeness and depth, requirement by requirement.

THE SIGNAL

"Missed or only partly answered": check each requirement, and its depth.

> Claude has drafted an incident report for a client after a water leak at one of their offices. The report draws on Halden's site log and the out-of-hours call records.
>
> The contract specifies the sections every incident report must contain.

Which two criteria are valid for evaluating this report? Choose two.

A The report sounds authoritative and confident

B Every time and fact matches the site log and call records

C The report is longer than last month's incident report

D Claude states that it is confident in the content

E It contains every section the contract requires

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two criteria are valid for evaluating this report? Choose two.

A The report sounds authoritative and confident

Tone, not truth. Confident text can be wrong.

B Every time and fact matches the site log and call records

Accuracy, checked against the sources.

C The report is longer than last month's incident report

Length is not a measure of quality.

D Claude states that it is confident in the content

Self-assessment is not evidence.

E It contains every section the contract requires

Completeness, checked against the specification.

THE SIGNAL

Two valid criteria, two external references: the records, and the contract.

> Claude recommends moving Halden's North region cleaners to a four-day rota. It cites savings figures from two internal documents.
>
> Those same two documents also estimate extra overtime costs and record a staff consultation concern. Neither appears in the recommendation.

Which concern is most warranted?

A. None: every citation supports the recommendation

B. Two sources are too few for a decision of this size, so reject it

C. It omits material counter-evidence from its own sources, so revise it to weigh both sides

D. Attach the overtime and consultation material as an appendix, and keep the recommendation as it is

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which concern is most warranted?

A None: every citation supports the recommendation

Correct citations can still be cherry-picked.

B Two sources are too few for a decision of this size, so reject it

The problem is what was left out, not how many sources there are.

C It omits material counter-evidence from its own sources, so revise it to weigh both sides

Names the real flaw and the right fix.

D Attach the overtime and consultation material as an appendix, and keep the recommendation as it is

Leaves a conclusion that never weighed the costs.

THE SIGNAL

The sources contain costs and concerns the output ignores: a one-sided recommendation.

A Halden finance manager receives a Claude-drafted business case for new floor-cleaning machines, along with the acceptance criteria the finance committee agreed.

She is about to review it.

Which step should she take first?

A Restate the agreed acceptance criteria, so the review measures against them

B Decide whether to use the business case, revise it, or escalate it

C Document each gap and inaccuracy she finds

D Compare the figures with the supplier quotes and usage data

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which step should she take first?

A Restate the agreed acceptance criteria, so the review measures against them

Sets the standard before reading. The sequence opens here.

B Decide whether to use the business case, revise it, or escalate it

The decision is the last step, not the first.

C Document each gap and inaccuracy she finds

Comes after comparing. Nothing has been found yet.

D Compare the figures with the supplier quotes and usage data

Essential, but done against criteria already restated.

THE SIGNAL

First step of an evaluation: restate the criteria. Last step: decide.

> Claude summarised an external audit of a client's site for the account director. Every figure in the summary is correct.
>
> The audit flagged two critical findings about fire-door checks. The summary does not mention them.

Which conclusion is best supported?

A The summary is accurate, so it is fit to send

B The summary is inaccurate, so it should be discarded

C It is accurate but incomplete, and unfit until the critical findings are added

D It is fine for internal use but should not go to the client

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which conclusion is best supported?

A The summary is accurate, so it is fit to send

Accuracy is only one test. It fails completeness.

B The summary is inaccurate, so it should be discarded

Nothing in it is wrong. It needs adding to, not discarding.

C It is accurate but incomplete, and unfit until the critical findings are added

Names both tests correctly, and the fix.

D It is fine for internal use but should not go to the client

The account director needs the critical findings most of all.

THE SIGNAL

Every sentence true, two critical findings missing: accurate, incomplete, not ready.

In five lines

- **Criteria and thresholds first**, before anything is read or scored.
- **Valid criteria point outside the draft:** sources, specification, audience.
- **Not criteria:** confidence, length, source count, self-assessment.
- **Sequence:** restate criteria, read, compare, document gaps, decide.
- **Accurate is not complete.** Check depth, and what the sources say that the output does not.

COMING UP

Next: hallucinations, inconsistencies and bias, and how to spot each one.